



Before sunrise, Little Wonderer found tiny drops on a leaf. A spider web beside it wore shining beads. "Did I miss the rain?" Little asked. The path was dry. Big Wonderer knelt beside the leaf. "Let's follow the clues back through the night."



The night had been clear and calm. The leaf gave off heat to the open sky. It cooled and could get colder than the air around it. Little began a list of nature's instructions: "1. Cool the leaf." Nothing had fallen from the sky.



Air holds water vapor, water in a gas form we cannot see. Air touching the cool leaf cooled too. At the dew point, it was cool enough that it could not keep all its water invisible. Little added: "2. Wait for the air to touch it."



Tiny drops formed right on the leaf. Water vapor had begun to condense: it changed from a gas into liquid water. That water was dew. The cool spider web held beads too. "3. Look for tiny drops," Little wrote. "They formed here. They did not fall like rain!"

WONDER DAILY

The drops that did not fall.

Little's instructions for dew



One leaf. Six steps. A story that keeps going.

GRADE 2

Make a little book.

1. Print one-sided: US Letter, portrait, actual size / 100%. No fit. Headers/footers off.
2. Fold long edge to long edge; reopen. Fold short edge to short edge, then in half again. Open: eight boxes.
3. Cut only the solid center line across the middle two boxes. Keep the outer boxes joined.
4. Refold long edge to long edge, print outside. Push ends together to open a diamond, then a cross.
5. Wrap into a book with page 1 in front. Follow pages 1 to 8.

Pictures are simplified and not to scale. Look closely, wonder, and pause whenever you like.



Little checked the order: cool the leaf, let air touch it, then notice dew. "My commands are like a little program," Little said. "But nature does not read my notebook!" Big smiled. The instructions helped Little explain the changes, one step at a time.



Sunrise warmed the leaf. The beads grew smaller as water began to evaporate: it changed from liquid back into invisible vapor. Little added one last command: "4. Warm the leaf." The water was not gone forever. It had returned to the air. What would the next night bring?